

Operational Definitions – Measure Phase

These definitions are written in plain language so everyone measures things the same way.

Metric	Operational Definition	How It Is Measured	In / Out of Scope	Notes
Checkout waiting time	Time from when a student joins the back of the line until payment is fully completed.	Cashier notes the time when the student enters the line and the time when payment is approved; difference in minutes is recorded.	In scope	Does not include time waiting for the drink after payment.
Long wait	Any checkout waiting time greater than 7 minutes.	Flagged when recorded waiting time is more than 7.0 minutes.	In scope	7 minutes chosen based on student feedback.
Abandoned order	A student leaves the line before reaching the cashier.	Staff mark a simple tally whenever they see someone leave the line without ordering.	In scope	Only counted if clearly visible to staff.
Active cashier count	Number of cashiers actively serving customers during the 8–10 a.m. window.	Supervisor notes how many registers are open at the start of each 15-minute block.	In scope	Used to see effect of staffing on wait times.
Payment method	Whether the customer pays with cash or card.	Cashier ticks “cash” or “card” on the timing sheet.	In scope	Helps compare wait times by payment method.